

After this, you will be provided with a list of applications; all you need to do is to enter the number of the program that you want to be the default.

—Jithesh E J,
igothackedbyfoss@gmail.com

Convert the Linux manual page to a normal text file

Here is a simple tip that will convert the output of a *man* page to a simple text file. This text file can be easily used for printing, or can be sent as an email. For example, to convert *man ls* to a text file, issue the following command:

```
man ls | col -b > /tmp/ls-man-page.txt
```

—Prasanna Mohanasundaram,
Prasanna.mohanasundaram@gmail.com

Colour your PuTTY Window

PuTTY is the most widely used tool for remote logins from Windows to a Linux computer. The default terminal window has a black background with white fonts. If you feel like changing it, you can easily do so. For example, for a white background with black font: start PuTTY. Go to the left panel. Under *Category*, click *Windows* → *Colours*. Check the box 'Use system colours'. Next, select *Session* in the left panel, click *Default Settings*, and click the *Save* button. The next time you open an SSH session, it will load with a white background and black font.

—Yogesh,
friendlyyogi@gmail.com

Open as the root

You can create a menu entry to open a selected item as the *root* in your current location. Just create a file, for instance, 'OpenAsRoot', in your *\$HOME/.gnome2/nautilus-scripts* directory, with the following contents:

```
$ cat > ~/.gnome2/nautilus-scripts/OpenAsRoot
#!/bin/bash
```

```
for uri in $NAUTILUS_SCRIPT_SELECTED_URIS; do
    gksudo "gnome-open $uri" &
done
```

Now, make that file executable by issuing the following command:

```
$ chmod 755 ~/.gnome2/nautilus-scripts/OpenAsRoot
```

And then restart Nautilus:

```
$ nautilus -q
```

This will make Nautilus use that script instantly. Now select the file(s), right-click, choose *Scripts* > *OpenAsRoot* and the file will be opened with *root* permissions.

—Rushyang Darji,
rushyangdarji@gmail.com

Changing the directory while using FTP

You do not need to close and restart your FTP session every time you change the local directory on your system. Instead, try the *lcd* command:

```
ftp> lcd /home/user2/dir2/
Local directory now /home/user2/dir2
ftp>
```

—Chekkizhar,
chekkezharayy@gmail.com

Reboot your non-responsive server

If you are having a hard time rebooting a Linux server, especially remotely, due to a drive failure or to high load averages, the *reboot* command may fail. The *sysrq-trigger* is a 'magic key' to hard-reboot the Linux server—but please note that since it's a hard reboot, it may lead to data loss or even file system corruption.

Before triggering the *sysrq-trigger*, you need to enable the *sysrq*, as follows:

```
# echo 1 > /proc/sys/kernel/sysrq
```

To enable the key permanently, use the following code:

```
# echo "kernel.sysrq = 1" >> /etc/sysctl.conf
# sysctl -p
```

Use the following command to trigger a hard reboot:

```
# echo b > /proc/sysrq-trigger
```

It is advisable to use the above option only under extreme conditions where the *reboot* command is not helpful or not responding.

—Pradeep P,
pradeep.nix@gmail.com

END

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